THE DEPARTMENT OF STATE

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The Post-War Period in the Far East

Address by JOHN CARTER VINCENT[1]

[Released to the press October 20]

Travel, unless undertaken out of curiosity or for fun, generally presupposes a destination. Foreign policy, unless undertaken out of curiosity or for fun, presupposes objectives. And in 1945 we can't afford foreign policy for fun or as a luxury.

We—the American people—must decide upon our objectives and then search for policies and implementing procedures best calculated to achieve our objectives. Objectives should be so clearly expressive of the national will as to arouse little controversy. On the other hand, policies to achieve these objectives may be, as we well know, subject to considerable debate. A policy pursued may of necessity represent not the most direct route toward an objective but a compromise of various views as to the best route to follow, or it may represent deviations along the route to meet special and immediate problems. These conditions often account for divergencies between policies followed by the Government and those advocated by independent writers and commentators.

A statement of objectives, as I have said, does not generally meet with these difficulties. I am therefore going to state a few broad objectives of foreign policy on which I believe we can all agree and then examine some of our policies in the light of those objectives. I realize in what I am about to say that our objectives have universal application and that our policies are in many instances also not limited to any special area. But I am talking about the Far East—at least that is what I was asked to do.

And I want to make one other, perhaps obvious, distinction clear: that is, the distinction between objectives and policies. Take, for example, two much-used words: *security* and *cooperation*. I have frequently heard international cooperation spoken of as an objective of our foreign policy. It is not. It is a policy to achieve our objectives, one of the most vital being the security of the United States. But lest you misunderstand me, let me add and emphasize that I consider international cooperation the most important of our foreign policies, *if* we are to achieve our security objective.

What are the objectives of our foreign policies that I have in mind? They can be stated quite simply. They are: (1) to provide for the security of the United States and the maintenance of international peace and (2) to create in the relations among states conditions conducive to mutually beneficial commercial and cultural exchanges which will promote international welfare and understanding.

In a joint statement issued from Chungking on June 24, 1944, Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek and Vice President Wallace enunciated an objective directly related to those I have stated. They said: "The objective of victory in the Pacific is the establishment of a democratic peace based on political and social stability deriving from government devoted to the welfare of peoples." They then, as I shall do, went on to name some policies which they considered essential to the achievement of that objective. They said: "Enduring peace in the Pacific will depend upon (1) effective, permanent demilitarization of Japan; (2) understanding, friendship, and collaboration between and among the four principal powers in the Pacific area—China, the Soviet Union, the United States, and the British Commonwealth of Nations—and among all United Nations willing to share in the responsibilities of post-war international order; and (3) recognition of the fundamental right of presently dependent Asiatic peoples to self-government, and the early adoption of measures in the political, economic, and social fields to prepare those dependent peoples for self-government within a specified practical time limit." I believe there will be found in America little or no disposition to question those policies.

[1] Made at the Foreign Policy Association Forum, "Between War and Peace," in New York, N. Y., on Oct. 20, 1945. Mr. Vincent is Director of the Office of Far Eastern Affairs, Department of State.

Our objectives in regard to the Far East can be generalized. Our policies cannot be. They must be adapted to meet divergent geographical, political, and social situations. In the Far East we have (1) a defeated and so far unregenerate Japan; (2) Korea, which is to start on the road to independence after two generations of subjection to Japan; (3) China, our Ally and long-time friend, whose principal problems, now that the menace of Japan has been removed, are political unity and economic reconstruction; (4) Siam, an independent nation which has for the past five years been under the domination of Japan; and (5) the colonial area of southeast Asia under the sovereignty of our Allies.

With regard to Japan, a White House release on September 22 gave in some 15 pages a clear summary of our policy toward Japan. It was entitled "U.S. Initial Post-Surrender Policy for Japan".[2] I commend it to you. I will mention also, but modesty forbids my commending it, a broadcast in which I participated two weeks ago on the same subject.[3] A brief quotation from the White House release may serve to refresh your interest.

"Japan will be completely disarmed and demilitarized. The authority of the militarists and the influence of militarism will be totally eliminated from her political, economic, and social life. Institutions expressive of the spirit of militarism and aggression will be vigorously suppressed.

". . . The Japanese people shall be encouraged to develop a desire for individual liberties and respect for fundamental human rights, particularly the freedoms of religion, assembly, speech, and the press. They shall also be encouraged to form democratic and representative organizations.

". . . The Japanese people shall be afforded opportunity to develop for themselves an economy which will permit the peacetime requirements of the population to be met."

We are all keenly interested in how these policies will be implemented. I hope this interest will remain keen—but not impatient. General MacArthur is in my opinion doing a good job. We should not try to "hustle" the East, or General MacArthur. Reform in the social, economic, and political structure of Japan must be a gradual process, wisely initiated and carefully fostered.

You are also no doubt interested in the proposed Far Eastern Advisory Commission. I am glad you are. So am I, although it will mean a lot of additional work. It is impossible to state here and now just how the Commission will operate. That will depend in large measure on the Commission, but I am confident that with General McCoy as our representative we will do our full share in making it work.

At present, and for the past 10 months, the State, War, Navy Coordinating Committee, called SWNCC, has been formulating policy for the President's approval on questions of basic importance, including those connected with the surrender and administration of Japan and of liberated areas in the Far East. I am chairman of the SWNCC Subcommittee for the Far East. This subcommittee devotes its energies to the preparation of policy papers and directives concerning Far Eastern matters. The subcommittee meets twice a week to consider papers presented by specialists on the various subjects under consideration. These papers, when approved, are submitted to the over-all State, War, Navy Committee, which is composed of high-ranking officials of the three departments. On the military aspects of papers, the views of the Joint Chiefs of Staff are obtained and carefully considered. Papers of basic importance, after being adopted by the top Committee, are submitted by the Secretary of State to the President for his approval.

The policy paper from which I have quoted was prepared in SWNCC and approved by the President. A reading of the subheadings in that document will give you an idea of some of the special subjects dealt with in our papers. Those headings include such subjects as war criminals; economic demilitarization; promotion of democratic forces; fiscal, monetary, and banking policies; equality of opportunity for foreign enterprise in Japan; individual liberties and democratic processes. One of them, entitled "Relationship to Japanese Government", calls for special mention. Shortly after the Japanese surrender to General MacArthur on September 9, the following message was sent to General MacArthur:

"1. The authority of the Emperor and the Japanese Government to rule the State is subordinate to you as Supreme Commander for the Allied

[2] BULLETIN of Sept. 23, 1945, p. 423.
[3] BULLETIN of Oct. 7, 1945, p. 538.

powers. You will exercise your authority as you deem proper to carry out your mission. Our relations with Japan do not rest on a contractual basis, but on an unconditional surrender. Since your authority is supreme, you will not entertain any question on the part of the Japanese as to its scope.

"2. Control of Japan shall be exercised through the Japanese Government to the extent that such an arrangement produces satisfactory results. This does not prejudice your right to act directly if required. You may enforce the orders issued by you by the employment of such measures as you deem necessary, including the use of force.

"3. The statement of intentions contained in the Potsdam Declaration will be given full effect. It will not be given effect, however, because we consider ourselves bound in a contractual relationship with Japan as a result of that document. It will be respected and given effect because the Potsdam Declaration forms a part of our policy stated in good faith with relation to Japan and with relation to peace and security in the Far East." [4]

This, I think, makes quite clear our interpretation of the Potsdam Declaration and also quite clear for General MacArthur what his relationship is to the Japanese Government.

In Korea our policy problems are both obvious and difficult.[5] Korea is to be separated from Japan and become an independent member of the family of nations. But Korea, after years of subjection to Japan, is not immediately prepared to exercise self-government. We therefore advocate a period of trusteeship during which Koreans will be prepared to take over the independent administration of their country. How long that will require neither you nor I can say; we will agree, however, that the briefer the period, the better.

The present division of Korea north and south of latitude 38 into Russian and American zones of occupation was made for military operational purposes and for purposes of surrender. It is manifestly unsatisfactory from the standpoint of administration of the country, and we hope to work out with our Soviet Allies, who are in the northern half of the country, a liaison and understanding which will solve many administrative problems prior to the establishment of a trusteeship in which we expect the Allies principally interested in Korea to participate.

In the southern half of Korea, which our military authorities are administering, a consultative council composed of Koreans has been established. Koreans from abroad are being encouraged to return to Korea to participate in this council and in the administration.

Our policy with regard to Korea is then to bring into being as quickly as possible an independent, democratic, and prosperous nation. As soon as it is feasible to do so, I should like to see American businessmen, missionaries, and cultural organizations established in Korea and contributing their share toward implementing American policies there.

In southeast Asia a situation has developed to the liking of none of us, least of all to the British, the French, the Dutch, and, I gather, to the Annamese and Indonesians. With regard to the situation in French Indochina, this Government does not question French sovereignty in that area. Our attitude toward the situation in the Dutch East Indies is similar to that in regard to French Indochina. In both these areas, however, we earnestly hope that an early agreement can be reached between representatives of the governments concerned and the Annamese and Indonesians. It is not our intention to assist or participate in forceful measures for the imposition of control by the territorial sovereigns, but we would be prepared to lend our assistance, if requested to do so, in efforts to reach peaceful agreements in these disturbed areas.

In a statement issued by Secretary Hull on March 21, 1944, entitled "Bases of the Foreign Policy of the United States",[6] there occurs the following paragraph in regard to "dependent peoples": "There rests upon the independent nations a responsibility in relation to dependent peoples who aspire to liberty. It should be the duty of nations having political ties with such peoples . . . to help the aspiring peoples to develop materially and educationally, to prepare themselves for the duties and responsibilities of self-government, and to attain liberty." This continues to be American policy.

With regard to Siam, we have never considered ourselves at war with that nation, although the Government in control in 1942 declared war on the

[4] BULLETIN of Sept. 30, 1945, p. 480.
[5] BULLETIN of June 10, 1945, p. 1058.
[6] BULLETIN of Mar. 25, 1944, p. 275.

United States. We consider Siam an independent and sovereign nation. It is our policy to foster friendly relations with Siam and encourage the development of healthy democratic institutions and a sound economy. We advocate the "Open Door" there, as in other areas, and equality of treatment by Siam of all nations and their nationals. The British Government, which declared war on Siam in response to Siam's declaration of war on Great Britain, is now negotiating at Kandy with the Siamese an agreement to terminate the state of hostilities. We have followed these negotiations and have reason to hope that they may be successfully concluded in the near future.[7]

Our policy toward our Ally China is clear and consistent. Our policy has been, is, and will be to encourage and assist, when we can appropriately do so, the development of a unified, strong, and cooperative nation with a government based on democratic principles and popular sovereignty. Our Ambassador, General Hurley, has worked unflaggingly for the realization of this policy. We fought side by side with China in a war against Japan which China entered four and a half years before we did. We shall continue to collaborate with China in the solution of its and our problems.

Generalissimo Chiang and Mao Tse-tung have recently announced a 12-point agreement in regard to the Kuomintang-Communist problem. No one who knows anything about conditions in China would argue that the agreement is definitive, but it allays the fears which were so lively a month ago that there would be wide-spread civil war in China, and it furnishes the framework for an adjustment of the differences between the Government, the Communists, and other non-government political groups in China.

At the root of China's difficulties is the need for certain economic reforms, particularly in the agrarian field and in the field of taxation. China's leaders realize this, and we may hope that, with the return of peace, they will set about instituting the necessary reforms. Much is written about the industrialization of China. But without reforms, one of the primary objectives of which would be to increase the individual incomes of the Chinese farmers, and without an expanded transportation system and a sound currency, industrial development would be meaningless to the Chinese people. It would rest on the insecure basis of foreign markets for its continued existence. American capital and technical know-how will be available to China, I am sure, if China's reconstruction follows the lines I have mentioned. There is every reason to believe that Chinese and American businessmen can develop and expand their commercial trade on a non-discriminatory and mutually beneficial basis. It is our policy to encourage commercial relations of this kind with China.

It is our policy to encourage and facilitate the reestablishment of American business in China. Probably not with all the speed desired, but with all the speed we can generate, we are endeavoring to get businessmen back into China for their sake and for China's sake. We want them back in Shanghai, Hong Kong, Tientsin, and other ports as quickly as possible. We are reopening consulates in these and other cities.

What I have said regarding American businessmen applies with equal force to missionaries and representatives of cultural and philanthropic organizations. We want them back in China as soon as transportation facilities and conditions in China will permit.

Some question may have arisen in your mind with regard to the dispatch of American Marines to north China. They have been sent there pursuant to military directives to serve a specific purpose, that is, to assist Chiang Kai-shek in demobilizing and repatriating Japanese troops in the area. Their stay is temporary. They will be withdrawn when they are no longer required for the purpose for which they were sent. Generalissimo Chiang has announced that the Marines would leave north China as soon as they can be relieved by Chinese Government forces. The process of relief is now in progress.

China is in a position to form a buffer or a bridge in our relations with the Soviet Union in the Far East. We will all agree, I believe, that the bridge concept is preeminently preferable, and that it should be our policy to make it a fact. I would go further and say that only through the cooperation of China, the U.S.S.R., and ourselves can the objectives of our policy in the Far East be achieved.

In August, the Chinese and Soviet Governments entered into certain agreements which we hope will stabilize the relations between those two countries. It will be our policy to cooperate with China and the Soviet Union for stability in the Far East. We will cooperate with neither of them in any policy directed against the other.

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[7] BULLETIN of Aug. 19, 1945, p. 261.

Secretary Byrnes has indicated that the United States desires cooperation with the Soviet Union on all matters of mutual concern. This attitude rests upon a recognition of the importance of amicable Soviet-American relations. We know that Russia has important interests in the Far East. We expect recognition by Russia that we also have important interests in that area. We shall, therefore, pursue policies consistent with our over-all objectives, best calculated to bring about Russian recognition of our position in the Far East and to accord fair recognition to the Russian position in that area—and further, to bring about a Russian understanding that our objectives in the Far East are in harmony with the objectives of any peacefully inclined nation.

In conclusion, let me recapitulate and pose some questions. Our objectives are (1) to provide for the security of the United States and the maintenance of international peace; (2) to create in the relations among states conditions conducive to mutually beneficial commercial and cultural exchanges which will promote international welfare and understanding; and (3) the related objective, stated by Generalissimo Chiang and Mr. Wallace, to establish a democratic peace based on political and social stability deriving from government devoted to the welfare of peoples.

Do we believe that a demilitarized and democratized Japan is in line with our objectives or do we believe that the revival of a pre-war Japan would better suit our purposes? The answer is clear and emphatic. We want a completely regenerate and reformed Japan.

Do we feel that the early development of an independent, democratic Korea is good policy, not simply because we have had a natural predilection for independence and democracy for three centuries, but because we believe that the development of such a Korean state would further our objectives? I am sure we do.

Do we desire the maintenance and strengthening of Siamese sovereignty and democracy because it would be "nice" for the Siamese or because it would contribute toward the realization of our objectives in the Far East? The answer, I suppose, is both. We can be sentimental as well as practical—as long as we *are* practical.

Similarly, do we feel that dependent peoples of southeast Asia should be assisted "to prepare themselves for the duties and responsibilities of self-government, and to attain liberty", to use Mr. Hull's words? Do we feel that recognition given to the self-governing aspirations of dependent peoples will be conducive to peace and well-being in the Far East? I believe we do.

And finally, are we sure that our desire for a unified and democratic China is not simply an expression of our traditional good-will toward the Chinese without reference to realities and our objectives? I am confident that we are. Without such a China peace in the Far East would be in serious jeopardy.

But—and this is my last word, or last paragraph, I should say—we must not fall into the error of considering the implementation of these policies and the realization of these objectives as our private and exclusive job. I have described international cooperation as a policy. It is a policy—but it is, to my mind, an overriding policy. We are to be a participant in the United Nations Organization. The operation of that Organization will not, as some seem to think, furnish a substitute for national foreign policies. It should be—we should make it—a convenient, an efficient, and an effective clearing-house for national foreign policies and for their reconciliation in the interests of international security, peace, and welfare. Therefore, and in conclusion, I would strongly advocate that the policies we pursue be able to stand careful international examination. I believe those I have summarized for the Far East will do so.

Visit of President Rios of Chile

Statement by PRESIDENT TRUMAN

[Released to the press by the White House October 31]

President Rios of Chile left Washington yesterday after an official visit, during which it was my privilege to have him as a guest at the White House. It was a great pleasure to meet him, not only as a friend and statesman but also as the representative of a democratic people and a fast-growing democracy.

We discussed the mutual desire to strengthen the solidarity of the republics of the Western Hemisphere on the basis of the ideals for which the war was fought and won.